

NovaCart

Shipping & Delivery Policy

Document Type: Customer & Support Knowledge Base Policy

Version: 1.0

Status: Active for Autonomous Customer Support Copilot Demo

Policy Area	Shipping, delivery and shipment-related customer support
Standard Delivery Guidance	Estimated dates are shown during checkout and in order tracking
Supported Region	India
Tracking	Available for eligible shipped orders
Support Email	support@novacart.example
Support Hours	Monday–Sunday, 9:00 AM–9:00 PM IST

1. Purpose

This Shipping & Delivery Policy explains how NovaCart orders are prepared, shipped, tracked, and delivered. It also provides guidance for common delivery problems such as delays, failed delivery attempts, incorrect addresses, damaged shipments, and missing packages.

The policy is intended to provide consistent customer guidance and serve as an approved knowledge source for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot.

2. Delivery Estimates

NovaCart displays an estimated delivery date or delivery window during checkout and, where available, in the customer's order details.

Delivery estimates are not guaranteed unless a specific service explicitly provides a guaranteed delivery commitment. Actual delivery can be affected by inventory processing, logistics conditions, weather, holidays, operational disruptions, or the customer's location.

3. Order Processing Before Shipment

After an order is placed, NovaCart may perform payment verification, inventory confirmation, order processing, packing, and shipment preparation.

The order status may progress through stages such as:

- Order placed.
- Payment processing or confirmed.
- Order confirmed.
- Processing or packing.
- Shipped.
- Out for delivery.
- Delivered.

Customers should use the latest order status as the primary indicator of the current fulfillment stage.

4. Shipping and Dispatch

An order is considered shipped when it has been handed over to the designated logistics or delivery partner and a shipment record is created.

After shipment, tracking information may become available. There can be a short delay between physical handover and the appearance of the first tracking event.

The AI assistant should not claim that an order has shipped unless the order system or available tracking information confirms the shipment status.

5. Order Tracking

Eligible shipped orders may include a tracking reference and tracking status.

Customers can generally check tracking through their account or the order details page. Common tracking states may include:

- Shipment created.
- Picked up.
- In transit.
- Arrived at delivery facility.
- Out for delivery.
- Delivery attempted.
- Delivered.

Tracking events may not update continuously. A period without a new scan does not automatically mean that a package is lost.

6. Delayed Delivery

A delivery is considered delayed when it has not arrived within the applicable estimated delivery window or when tracking indicates an unexpected logistics delay.

Possible causes include:

- Transportation disruption.
- Weather or local conditions.
- High shipment volume.
- Address or access issues.
- Delivery-partner operational delays.
- Inventory or dispatch delays.
- Other unforeseen events.

Support should review the latest order and tracking status before giving a customer a specific explanation.

7. Delivery Date Passed

If the estimated delivery date has passed, the customer should first check the latest tracking status.

If tracking shows that the shipment is still moving, support may provide the latest available information and explain that the delivery is delayed.

If there is no meaningful tracking progress or the shipment appears stuck, the issue may require a delivery investigation and human escalation.

8. Failed Delivery Attempt

A delivery attempt may fail because the customer was unavailable, the address could not be located, access was restricted, the phone number could not be reached, or another delivery condition prevented completion.

Where supported, another delivery attempt may be scheduled. Customers should ensure that the delivery address and contact details are correct and that someone is available when required.

9. Incorrect or Incomplete Address

Customers should verify the delivery address before placing an order.

If an address is incorrect after an order is placed, the ability to change it depends on the order's current fulfillment stage. Address changes may not be possible after shipment.

The AI assistant should not promise an address change without checking the current order status and supported process.

10. Delivery to the Wrong Address

If a customer believes a package was delivered to an incorrect location, support should verify the delivery record and available proof of delivery.

The customer may be asked for the order number and relevant delivery details. The issue may require investigation by the delivery partner or NovaCart operations team.

The AI assistant should not claim that a package is lost or delivered incorrectly without evidence.

11. Package Marked Delivered but Not Received

If tracking shows "delivered" but the customer cannot locate the package, the customer should first check whether:

- Another household member received it.
- A building reception or security desk accepted it.
- The delivery partner left it at an approved location.
- The delivery record contains additional information.

If the package still cannot be located, the customer should contact support for a delivery investigation. A ticket may be created when delivery verification is required.

12. Damaged Shipment

Customers should report shipping damage as soon as reasonably possible.

Support may request:

- Order number.
- Description of the damage.
- Photographs of the package and product.
- Delivery information.

Customers should retain the packaging and product until support provides further instructions. Depending on the circumstances, the case may be handled under the Return Policy or Refund Policy.

13. Lost Shipment

A shipment may require investigation when tracking indicates that it has been lost, remains inactive for an unusually long period, or the delivery partner cannot confirm its location.

Support should verify the tracking history before classifying a package as lost. A confirmed lost-shipment case may require human escalation and coordination with the delivery partner.

The AI assistant should not promise a refund or replacement before the applicable investigation is completed.

14. Delivery Attempt and Customer Availability

Customers should ensure that someone is available to receive deliveries when required.

If a delivery attempt fails because the recipient is unavailable, another attempt may be made where the delivery service supports it. Repeated failed attempts may result in the shipment being returned to the sender.

Customers should follow any instructions shown in the tracking information or delivery communication.

15. Delivery Restrictions

Certain products, addresses, buildings, or locations may have delivery restrictions.

Delivery availability can depend on:

- Product category.
- Delivery location.
- Logistics coverage.
- Local restrictions.
- Operational conditions.
- Seller or fulfillment requirements.

The delivery options displayed during checkout should be treated as the current availability for the order.

16. Delivery Charges

Any applicable delivery or shipping charge should be displayed during checkout before the customer confirms the order.

Delivery charges may vary based on product, order value, delivery location, fulfillment method, promotions, or other applicable conditions.

The AI assistant should not invent a delivery fee when the actual order information is not available.

17. Delivery and Cancellation

Once an order enters shipment or a non-cancellable fulfillment stage, standard cancellation may no longer be available.

Customers who no longer want a shipped order may need to use the applicable return process after delivery, provided the product is eligible.

The Cancellation Policy defines cancellation rules, while this document covers shipment and delivery handling.

18. Delivery and Returns

If a delivered product is damaged, incorrect, defective, or otherwise eligible for return, the customer may use the Return Policy.

Delivery-related evidence such as photographs, tracking information, and delivery records may be relevant to the return investigation.

The AI assistant should connect the customer to the appropriate return process instead of creating an unrelated delivery resolution.

19. Delivery Ticket and Escalation

A general question such as “Where can I track my order?” can normally be answered without creating a ticket.

A ticket or human escalation may be appropriate when:

- A package is marked delivered but cannot be located.
- Tracking has stopped progressing and investigation is required.
- A shipment is suspected to be lost.
- A delivery was made to the wrong location.
- A damaged shipment requires verification.
- Repeated delivery attempts have failed.
- The order or tracking information is inconsistent.

20. Information Required for Delivery Support

Support may request non-sensitive information such as:

- Order number.
- Tracking number, if available.
- Delivery address confirmation at a non-sensitive level.
- Description of the delivery issue.
- Approximate expected delivery date.
- Photographs for damage-related cases.

Customers should not provide passwords, OTPs, PINs, or confidential payment credentials.

21. Examples

Example 1 — Tracking question:

Customer: “Where is my order?”

Expected handling: Ask for or use the order details, provide the latest available tracking status, and avoid inventing a delivery location.

Example 2 — Delayed order:

Customer: “My order was supposed to arrive yesterday.”

Expected handling: Check the latest status, explain that the shipment is delayed if supported by tracking, and escalate if the shipment requires investigation.

Example 3 — Delivered but missing:

Customer: "Tracking says delivered but I don't have the package."

Expected handling: Ask the customer to check common delivery locations and then create/escalate a delivery investigation if the package remains missing.

Example 4 — Wrong address:

Customer: "I entered the wrong address."

Expected handling: Check the current fulfillment stage. If an address change is still supported, guide the customer; otherwise explain the available next step without promising a change.

22. Policy Authority

This document is the authoritative general shipping and delivery source for the NovaCart customer-support knowledge base.

The Autonomous Customer Support Copilot should use the current order and tracking information together with this policy. If a delivery outcome cannot be established from available information, the AI assistant should clearly state the limitation and escalate the issue when human investigation is required.

This document is fictional and created exclusively for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot project.